
N° 04

The Income *System.*

All the tools, software and AI I use to build my businesses and make money online. The exact setup. Took me years to figure out. All in one place.

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A NOTE BEFORE YOU START

This book is the playbook I'd hand my younger self. The mindset, the stack, the playbooks, the practical. Read it like a manual. Put it down. Go build.

FRONT MATTER

Why this *exists*.

I worked in hospitality in Dubai. Eight, ten hours a day. Smiling at people who were on the holidays I couldn't afford. Putting money into someone else's pocket while my own life waited.

One day it landed. I was trading my hours for someone else's freedom. Not for a future. Not for a business that was mine. Just for a wage. The maths didn't work and the years were running.

That's where this book starts. Not at a six-figure month. Not at a guru moment. At the kitchen of a hotel restaurant, realising I needed out.

What came next

I got into *online trading*. Currencies. It worked. It funded my lifestyle and it funded the next move. People will tell you trading doesn't work. For me, at that time, it did. It bought me the time to figure out what came after.

What came after was *ecommerce*. I put together a team of people who knew the stack. Store setup, back end, advertising. We ran it, it made money, it ran its course. I learned how to build with other people and how to spot the right ones.

Then a *perfume vending business*. Real machines. High-end perfumes. Pay-per-spray inside restaurants and clubs. Still running today in Dubai and Thailand. Physical, passive, completely different beast.

Then a *chat support and virtual assistant business*. First three months I earned nothing. I pushed through. It became real. I sold it in December, clean exit. It opened doors and a network that I'm still pulling from.

Five different shapes of business. Online. Offline. Solo. With teams. Sold. Still running. The thing that connected all of them was not a magic skill. It was the willingness to start, the discipline to keep going, and a stack of tools that kept getting better.

What this book is

This is the playbook I'd hand my younger self. The mindset, the tools, the workflows, the playbooks. The exact stack I use today to build whatever I want.

It is not a "make \$10k in 30 days" book. There is no such book that is honest.

It is a book about *freedom*. The kind that comes from building things that earn while you sleep, while you travel, while you live on your own terms. The kind that you build with your brain, your hands, your discipline, and the best tools that have ever existed for people who want to make things.

MY TAKE

Freedom is the thing. Not money. Money is just what buys you the time to chase it.

FRONT MATTER

How to use *this book*.

Don't read it like a novel. Read it like a manual. Then put it down and go build something.

The four parts

Part 1 is mindset. The way you have to think before any of the rest of it matters. If you skip this, the tools won't save you.

Part 2 is the stack. Every tool I actually use. AI, builders, design, productivity, payments, communication, content. Real list, not a sponsored one.

Part 3 is the playbooks. How I actually build things. Including a worked example of how this exact site, EVLVED.com, was put together.

Part 4 is the practical. Getting paid, staying organised, when to hire, and the real mistakes I've made so you can make different ones.

How to actually read this

- Read Part 1 once. All of it. Slowly.
- Skim Part 2. Bookmark the tools that match what you want to build.
- Use Part 3 as a template. Don't copy. Adapt.
- Come back to Part 4 every time something goes sideways. It will.

MY TAKE

*You learn this stuff by **doing** it. The book is a map. You still have to walk.*

One rule before we start

Don't read the next page until you've decided what you want to build. Not the exact thing. Not the polished pitch. Just the rough shape of it.

If you don't have one yet, that's the first thing Part 1 fixes.

PART ONE

The *mindset.*

Before the tools, before the stack, before the playbooks. The way you have to think to make any of this work.

PART 1 · MINDSET

Freedom is the goal, *not money.*

Money is a tool. Freedom is the thing you build with it. Mix those up and you'll work your whole life and never get there.

Most people aim at money. They want a number in the bank, a salary, a payout. They get it and they wonder why they still feel trapped. The reason is simple. They never named what they actually wanted, so they bought whatever the world told them to want.

Money in the bank with no time to spend it is not freedom. It's a different cage.

What freedom actually looks like

For me, freedom is being able to wake up where I want. Work on what I want. Travel when I want. Help the people I love without checking a balance. Build the things I find interesting without a boss approving the brief.

That's it. There's no yacht in there. There's no Lamborghini. There might be one day, but it's not the goal. The goal is the absence of being told.

You should write down your own version of this before you do anything else. One paragraph. What freedom looks like to you. Specifically. Not "rich." Not "happy." What does Tuesday at 11am look like when you have it.

MY TAKE

If you can't describe what freedom looks like on a normal Tuesday, you'll never know when you've got it.

Why this matters before the tools

Because the tools are infinite. There is always a new AI, a new platform, a new course, a new shortcut. If you don't have a clear target, you'll spend the rest of your life optimising tools and never building anything.

Your target is freedom. Your tools serve it. Not the other way around.

Money plays a role

I'm not saying money doesn't matter. It does. You need it to live, to invest, to take time off, to take risks. The point is that money is the fuel. Freedom is the destination.

People who get this build differently. They don't chase the highest-paying thing. They chase the thing that gets them closer to their version of free, and let the money follow.

Sometimes the money comes faster that way. Sometimes slower. But the life you build along the road is one you'd actually want to live.

PART 1 · MINDSET

How to *think*.

You can build anything you want with a stack of AIs and an imagination. It's not hard. Most people just don't believe that sentence, so they never test it.

This is the most important page in the book. If you take one thing from it, take this: the gap between you and the thing you want to build is smaller than it has ever been in human history. The only thing missing is the willingness to start without a permission slip.

Imagination is the bottleneck now

Ten years ago the bottleneck was skill. You couldn't build a website without knowing HTML. You couldn't make a video without owning a camera and editing software. You couldn't reach an audience without paying a gatekeeper.

That's gone. AI builds the website. Your phone shoots the video. The internet is the audience.

What's left is the imagination to know what to build, the taste to know if it's any good, and the discipline to keep going when it isn't yet.

MY TAKE

*The skill is no longer the moat. **Imagination and execution** are the moat. That's the whole game now.*

How I actually think about a new project

I'll show you the exact process. It's not complicated.

1. **What does the finished thing look like?** Picture it as a real, working object. A site you can click. A product you can hold. A service you can describe in one sentence.
2. **What's the smallest version of it I could ship this week?** Not the full vision. The smallest piece that still works. The minimum thing someone could pay for or use.

3. **What's the first move?** One concrete action I can take in the next hour. Not "research." Not "plan." A specific thing. Buy the domain. Write the first page. Build the first screen.
4. **Do it. Now.** Before I lose the thread.

The trap of overthinking

Most people get stuck between step 1 and step 2. They picture the finished thing, get scared by how big it is, and never start.

Don't do that. The finished thing is years away. The smallest version is a week away. Build the smallest version. Then the next one. Then the next. The big thing builds itself out of the small things if you don't quit.

Problems are your raw material

The best businesses come from problems. Yours, your friends', your industry's. If something annoys you enough that you'd pay to fix it, that's a business waiting to be built.

The next time you're frustrated about something, don't complain. Write it down. That's your list of possible companies.

MY TAKE

Every business I've built started as a problem I had or saw. Not as a market opportunity. Just a thing that bugged me.

PART 1 · MINDSET

Why most people *fail*.

They consume instead of doing. They wait to be taught instead of going to find out. That's the whole reason. Not talent, not luck, not capital.

I know people who have watched a thousand hours of YouTube on building businesses and never shipped one. I know other people who barely watch anything and have three things running. The difference is not information. The difference is the willingness to do the thing badly the first time.

The consume loop

Here's the loop most people are stuck in. Recognise it because it's everywhere.

1. Get an idea.
2. Feel excited.
3. Decide you need to "learn" first.
4. Watch videos, read articles, buy a course.
5. Feel like you're making progress (you're not).
6. Hit a wall, get bored, get distracted.
7. Drop it. Get a new idea. Go to step 1.

This loop can run for years. People in their thirties are still in it. The output after five years of this loop is zero.

The build loop

Here's the loop that actually produces things.

1. Get an idea.
2. Start building it the same day. Badly is fine.
3. Hit a wall.
4. Learn the one thing you need to get past that wall. Just that thing.
5. Keep going.
6. Ship something. Anything.

7. Iterate. Or kill it. Move to the next idea with what you learned.

The first loop optimises for feeling productive. The second loop optimises for being productive. They look similar from the outside. They produce wildly different lives.

MY TAKE

*You don't learn by preparing to learn. You learn by **doing** the thing, hitting the wall, and figuring out how to climb it.*

What "doing" actually means

It means opening the software. Now. Today. With the idea you have right now, not the better one you'll have in a month.

It means writing the first ugly version. Making the first ugly site. Shipping the first ugly product. Trusting that ugly version one beats imagined version ten every time.

It means being okay looking like an amateur because that's what you are at the start of every new thing. Everyone is. The only difference is whether you stay an amateur or whether you push through the embarrassing beginner phase fast enough to become competent.

Permission

One more thing. Nobody is going to give you permission to start. There is no green light coming. There is no qualification you need first. There is no point at which you'll feel "ready."

You start because you decide to. That's the whole mechanism.

PART 1 · MINDSET

How to learn *any software, fast.*

I don't learn from videos. I don't learn from docs. I learn by opening the thing, breaking it, asking AI when I'm stuck, and keeping going. That's my whole method.

Most people approach a new tool the wrong way. They want to "learn" it first. They want a complete map before they take the first step. So they buy a tutorial series, watch hours of someone else clicking around, and absorb maybe ten percent of it.

I do the opposite. I open the tool with a specific job to do. I start clicking. When I hit something I don't understand, I ask. When something breaks, I fix it or find a workaround. By the time I'm done with the first project, I know the tool better than someone who watched a course on it.

The exact method

Step 01

Pick a real project, not a practice project.

Don't open the tool and play with it. Open it with a real job. A site you actually want to ship. A spreadsheet you actually need. The stakes make you learn faster because you can't afford to give up.

Step 02

Click everything in the first ten minutes.

Before you try to do anything serious, just click around. See what's in every menu. Don't take notes. You're just building a rough mental map of where things live.

Step 03

Start the project. Get stuck on purpose.

The fastest way to learn is to attempt something just past your current skill. Try the thing. When you hit the wall, you'll have a very specific question to ask.

Step 04

Ask AI, not Google.

For most software questions, Claude or ChatGPT will give you a better answer faster than scrolling through forum threads. Paste a screenshot, describe what's broken, ask. Three minutes instead of thirty.

Step 05

Ship something ugly.

Finish version one even if it looks bad. Finishing teaches you more than improving ever will. You can polish in the second pass. The first pass is to prove you can get to the end.

MY TAKE

*You don't learn software by **watching** it. You learn by **using** it. The hours people spend on tutorials, I spend on projects. Same time, completely different output.*

One more thing about AI as a teacher

The biggest unlock of the last few years is having a competent expert available 24/7 who will explain anything to you at the level you need. Use it. When something doesn't make sense, ask why. When you want to know what a button does, ask. When you're stuck, paste the screen and describe what you wanted to happen.

The barrier to learning has never been this low. Most people still aren't using it. Be the one who does.

PART TWO

The *stack*.

Every tool I actually use to build, ship, and run my businesses. AI, builders, design, finance, productivity, comms, content. No sponsors, no fillers.

PART 2 · THE STACK

The daily *AI core*.

Three tools I open every day. They cover ninety percent of what I do. Everything else in this book is built on top of these.

BUILDER & BRAIN**Claude**

My main tool for actually building things. Sites, scripts, documents, plans, products. I describe what I want, it builds it, we iterate. The thinking-out-loud and the coding both live here. Strong for long, careful work where mistakes cost you.

CONVERSATION & OVERFLOW**ChatGPT**

I use it to talk through ideas and to spread load when I'm hitting Claude's limits. Different models for different jobs. Good fallback, good second opinion. If Claude says one thing, sometimes I'll cross-check with ChatGPT and see if they agree.

LOCAL AGENT**OpenClaw AI**

Personal AI agent that runs on my machine. Can actually do things, not just talk about them. Browse, read and write files, run commands, manage tasks across the apps I already use. The "AI with hands" that closes the loop between chat and action.

MY TAKE

*Claude and OpenClaw build. ChatGPT talks. I use ChatGPT to save my Claude limits for the heavy lifting. **Stack them, don't pick one.***

How I actually split the work

Building a site, an app, a long document, anything where mistakes are expensive: *Claude*.

Thinking out loud, getting unstuck, exploring an idea, casual back-and-forth: *ChatGPT*.

Anything that needs to actually touch my files or run on my machine: *OpenClaw*.

That's the split. It's not religious. Sometimes I cross over. But that's the default.

If you're starting from zero

Get Claude. That's the one. Free tier works for testing. Pro plan is worth it the moment you're using it for real work, which will be week one.

Add ChatGPT when you find yourself bouncing off Claude's limits. Add OpenClaw when you want AI to actually do things on your machine instead of just answering you.

PART 2 · THE STACK

The stack to *build & ship a site.*

This is the exact toolchain I used to build EVLVED.com. Eight tools. Most are free or close to it. Every one of them does one job well.

01 · BUILD

Claude

I describe the site, Claude writes the HTML, CSS, and JavaScript. Pages, components, forms, the whole thing. I review, ask for changes, iterate. No "learning to code" required, but the more you understand what's happening, the better the result.

02 · VERSION CONTROL

GitHub

Source of truth. Every change to the site lives here. Free for personal projects. Connects to Vercel so deploys happen automatically every time you push a new version.

03 · DEPLOY

Vercel or Netlify

Both are free for small sites, both deploy in seconds, both handle SSL automatically. I use Vercel for most things now. Netlify is the same idea with a slightly different interface. Pick one and stick with it.

04 · DOMAIN

GoDaddy

Where I buy domains. They're not the cheapest but they're reliable and the DNS interface is easy to navigate. Domains are usually \$10-15 per year. Don't pay for extras you don't need.

05 · DATABASE

Supabase

When you need to store anything (users, signups, orders, content) Supabase gives you a real database without setting up a server. Free tier covers most projects until you have real traffic.

06 · EMAIL CAPTURE

Kit.com

Used to be ConvertKit. Free up to 10,000 subscribers. Forms, automations, sequences, broadcasts. I use it to capture emails and send launch announcements. Custom signup forms can be wired directly into your site.

07 · EMAIL FORWARDING

ImprovMX

Free forwarding for your domain email. info@yoursite.com forwards into your real inbox without needing to pay for a full Google Workspace seat. Useful early. Upgrade later when you want to send from the address as well.

08 · LOGOS & BRAND

Claude or Canva

For the logo and brand work, Claude can generate SVG marks and design tokens directly. Canva is the fallback if you want to drag things around yourself. Either works. Don't pay a designer for version one.

MY TAKE

*This is the stack that built every site I've made recently, including **EVLVED.com**. It's free or near-free, it scales, and you can stand up a working site with a custom domain and email capture in a day.*

PART 2 · THE STACK

The no-code *builders*.

If you don't want to touch any code at all, these tools let you build real websites by describing or designing them. They're not as flexible as Claude-built sites, but they're fast.

AI WEB BUILDER

Lovable 2.0

You describe the site, it generates the whole thing. Pages, components, logic. One of the strongest AI-native builders right now. Good for SaaS-style projects and dashboards.

AI WEB BUILDER

Readdy

Same idea as Lovable, different flavour. Describe your site, get a working version, refine. Useful as a second opinion if Lovable gives you something you don't love.

AI WEB BUILDER

Emergent

Another in this category. Different strengths on different days. Test all three with the same brief and pick whichever output is closest to what you want, then refine from there.

AI WEB BUILDER

Appalchemistry

Leans towards app-style projects. If you're thinking about something with users, accounts, or a real product loop, worth testing here too.

AI DECKS & SITES

Gamma

Generates presentations and lightweight sites from prompts. Brilliant for pitch decks, simple landing pages, anything you'd otherwise build in Keynote or Google Slides. Output is usable in minutes.

MY TAKE

These are all good. But honestly, Claude plus Vercel beats every one of them for serious work. The trade-off is you have to understand what code is. No-code is faster to start. Code is further to go.

When to pick no-code

- You need something working today, not next week.
- You're testing an idea and don't want to invest in real infrastructure yet.
- You're allergic to code and will quit if you have to touch it.
- The site is simple enough that the no-code template gets you 90% of the way there.

When to pick Claude + code

- You want full control over how it looks and behaves.
- The site needs custom logic that no template handles.
- You're building something you'll grow and maintain for years.
- You want to actually learn how the web works.

PART 2 · THE STACK

AI *agents*.

Beyond the daily three, there's a category of tools that act more like assistants than chatbots. They go and do things across the web, not just answer.

ALL-IN-ONE AGENT

Genspark

A super-agent that combines search, image, audio, video, and document tools. You give it a job, it figures out which tools to use. Useful when you want one tool to handle a messy multi-step task instead of stitching together five.

When to use an agent vs a chatbot

A chatbot answers. An agent does. If you want to talk through an idea, use Claude or ChatGPT. If you want something done across multiple steps, multiple sources, or multiple tools, reach for an agent.

Honest take: the agent space is still moving fast. The right tool today may not be the right tool in six months. Don't over-commit to any one. Stay curious, test new ones as they come out, and keep your workflow loose enough to swap things in and out.

MY TAKE

*Agents are still finding their shape. Use them, but don't build your whole business on top of one yet. **Tools change. Skills don't.***

PART 2 · THE STACK

Design *& brand.*

You don't need a design degree to make things that look good. You need a few tools and the taste to know when to stop.

LOGOS & MARKS

Claude

Surprisingly good for SVG logos and brand marks. Describe the feeling you want, get back a working SVG. Iterate until it's right. Faster than briefing a designer and free.

DRAG & DROP DESIGN

Canva

For everything that's not code. Social posts, banners, story templates, simple flyers. The free tier is genuinely useful. Pro plan unlocks brand kits and is worth it once you're posting regularly.

DIAGRAMS & VISUALS

Napkin AI

Turns text into clean visual diagrams in seconds. Useful for newsletters, pitch decks, blog posts, anywhere you want to break up a wall of words without spending hours in design software.

AI AD CREATIVE

The AI Admaker

Generates ad creative variations from a single prompt or product image. If you're running paid ads at any scale, this saves the back-and-forth with a designer for every test.

AI VISUALS

Higgsfield

Image and video generation with strong control over style and motion. Good for hero images, social content, anything where you want generated visuals that don't look obviously generated.

MY TAKE

*Taste is the new skill. The tools are free. The thing that separates good output from bad is whether you can tell the difference and **iterate until it's right**.*

How to develop taste fast

- Save things you like. Build a folder of references. Look at it often.
- Copy good design intentionally for practice. You'll see what makes it work.
- Ship things. Get feedback. Notice what you wince at six months later.
- Cut more than you add. Most amateur design has too much in it.

PART 2 · THE STACK

Video & *UGC*.

Video is the highest-leverage format on the internet right now. AI tools have collapsed the cost of making it. These are the ones I've used or kept on the list.

AI UGC ADS**Arcads**

Generates AI avatar UGC-style ads. You give it a script, pick an avatar, get a video. Useful for testing ad creative at scale without hiring creators for every variation.

AI VIDEO ADS**Creatify**

Same category, different approach. Generates engaging short-form ads from a product URL or brief. Good for ecommerce.

VERTICAL VIDEO**Vidalgo**

One-click vertical video generation. Designed for the TikTok, Reels, Shorts format. Quick way to repurpose horizontal content.

AI VIDEO ADS**Nemo**

AI ad video editor. Different feel than Arcads or Creatify. Worth keeping in the rotation when you want a different look.

AI SPOKESPERSON**HeyGen**

AI avatar that speaks your script. Translates videos into other languages with lip-sync. Useful for explainer content and international markets.

AI VIDEO GENERATOR**ClipZap**

General-purpose AI video generation. Another option in this fast-moving space.

NEXT-GEN VIDEO**Kling AI**

High-quality AI video generation. Newer model, strong outputs. Good for hero shots and short cinematic pieces.

POWER-USER WORKFLOWS

ComfyUI

Node-based workflow tool for serious image and video generation. Steeper learning curve, vastly more control. For when the consumer tools stop being enough.

MY TAKE

*You don't need all of these. Pick two. Run with them. The category is moving so fast that whichever you pick today won't be the best in six months anyway. **Skill over tools.***

PART 2 · THE STACK

Productivity *& organisation.*

I use five tools to stay organised. Digital and analogue, mixed together. They all do something different and none of them replaces the others.

STRUCTURED BRAIN

Notion

For anything that needs structure. Project pages, knowledge bases, content pipelines, lists I'll come back to. Flexible enough that you can shape it however your brain works.

PROJECT MANAGEMENT

Monday.com

For tracking work with multiple moving pieces. Boards, statuses, comments. Especially good when other people are involved. I leave comments and notes inside the boards instead of in chat where they get lost.

QUICK CAPTURE

Apple Notes

For things I need to capture in two seconds. Voice memos converted to text, screenshots, half-formed ideas. The lowest friction tool wins for capture.

BIG-PICTURE THINKING

Whiteboard

Physical, on the wall. For mapping out a business, a project, a quarter. Big enough that you can step back and see the whole shape. Things look different on a wall than on a screen.

DAILY COMPANION

Notebook

Handwritten. For daily lists, sketches, things I want to remember without a screen. Writing by hand makes me think differently. Worth the friction.

MY TAKE

*Digital tools don't replace paper. They work **together**. The whiteboard sees what the screen can't. Use both, every day.*

The rule

Use whatever stays out of your way. Tools that are too "perfect" become a hobby. You spend more time organising than doing. If your system needs a tutorial, it's wrong.

My setup is messy. That's fine. Messy and used beats clean and abandoned every time.

PART 2 · THE STACK

Finance *& payments.*

Five tools cover banking, getting paid online, moving money across borders, and tracking expenses. You don't need accounting software. You need a clean Google Sheet.

DAILY BANKING

Revolut

Multi-currency, low FX fees, virtual cards on demand. My daily card for spending and moving between currencies. Free tier works for most people. Premium tier is worth it if you're travelling constantly.

INTERNATIONAL MONEY

Wise

For sending and receiving money across countries at near-mid-market rates. Local account details in multiple currencies. Pair with Revolut. They overlap, but each does something the other doesn't quite.

BANKING BACKBONE

Local bank

Keep one. Revolut and Wise are great until they're not. A real bank in your home country is the foundation. Wire transfers, tax authority links, backstop when the fintech stack glitches.

GET PAID ONLINE

Stripe

The default for taking payments online. Cards, subscriptions, one-offs, invoices. Connects to almost everything. Setup takes an hour. Fees are reasonable. If you sell anything digital, you'll touch Stripe.

TRACK EXPENSES

Google Sheets

A clean spreadsheet, organised in folders in Google Drive. Income, expenses, by month, by business. That's it. Don't pay for accounting software until your accountant tells you to.

MY TAKE

*You don't need an accounting suite. You need a sheet, clean folders, and the discipline to update it monthly. **Simple beats fancy.***

One rule

Have two of everything. Two cards on different networks (Visa + Mastercard). Two banks at minimum. Two ways to receive money. Things break, accounts get frozen, fraud happens. Redundancy is how you stay liquid.

PART 2 · THE STACK

Communication.

I don't use one tool for everything. I meet people where they are. That means three messaging apps, project comments on Monday, and email when it has to be formal.

COMMUNITIES & TEAMS

Discord

For communities, mastermind groups, teams of collaborators. Better than Slack for less formal coordination. Free, scales to thousands of people, voice channels when you need them.

DIRECT MESSAGING

Telegram

For one-on-one and small groups with people in different countries. Reliable, fast, works on weak connections. The standard for a lot of international business contacts.

CASUAL & LOCAL

WhatsApp

For friends, family, anyone who's already on it (which is most of the world). The default in many regions. You'll end up using it whether you want to or not.

PROJECT COMMENTS

Monday.com

When the comment is about a specific task, it goes in the comments on the task. Not in chat. This is the single biggest rule for staying organised when you work with others. Comments on tasks survive. Chat doesn't.

WHEN IT HAS TO BE FORMAL

Email

For first contact with serious people, contracts, anything you want a permanent record of. Don't use chat apps for things that need to be findable in a year.

MY TAKE

Meet people where they are. Don't make them come to your preferred app. The fastest reply wins, every time.

PART 2 · THE STACK

Content.

If your business runs on content, you need this set. Mine doesn't run primarily on content, so I keep it minimal. Four tools, all I need.

IN-APP VIDEO

Instagram Edits

The native editor inside Instagram. Fast for stories, simple reels, anything you want to ship without leaving the app. Good enough for most posts.

VIDEO EDITOR

CapCut

For real edits. Cuts, transitions, captions, music, the works. Free, mobile and desktop. Industry standard for short-form right now.

POSTS & GRAPHICS

Canva

For static posts, story templates, carousels. Drag and drop. Templates that look professional out of the box. Pro tier when you want brand kits and resize-to-everything.

POSTS & GRAPHICS

Claude

For when you want a custom-built graphic, infographic, or carousel that doesn't look like every Canva template. Describe what you want, get HTML/SVG, export.

MY TAKE

Most people overbuy content tools and under-post. Pick the simplest stack that lets you ship something every day. Volume beats production value at the start.

One thing I don't use

A scheduler. I post manually. There are tools (Later, Buffer, Hootsuite) that schedule for you, and they're fine. I just haven't needed one. The act of posting reminds me to

engage with what I posted. A scheduler removes that loop, and the engagement loses something.

Try without one first. Add it later if you actually find yourself batching content. Don't add it because everyone says you should.

PART THREE

The *playbooks*.

How I actually build things. A worked example, two more approaches, and one principle to tie them together.

PART 3 · PLAYBOOKS

How I built *EVLVED.com*.

A real, recent example. Built from zero with the stack you saw in Part 2. End to end. The exact steps so you can do the same for whatever you want to make.

This is not a polished case study written six months after the fact. This is what actually happened, in roughly the order it happened.

I'll skip the parts that don't matter. The interesting parts are the decisions, the tool choices, and the order of operations. If you copy the order, you can build anything similar in a week or two.

The brief I started with

Four digital systems on the four pillars I care about: discipline, fitness, travel, income. Sold individually, sold as a bundle. The site is the entry point. Email capture before launch. Premium feel. Honest voice. Not a guru. Not a course. Just the systems.

That's all I had on day one. No design. No copy. No domain. No stack chosen.

STEP 01 · DOMAIN

Bought evlved.com on GoDaddy.

Took ten minutes. Cost about \$15 for the year. I knew the brand name before I started anything else, which made this easy. If you're still naming, that comes first.

STEP 02 · HOSTING

Created a Vercel account and a GitHub repo.

Vercel deploys from GitHub automatically. Push code to GitHub, Vercel rebuilds the site. Free for projects this size. The repo is called evlved.com, the Vercel project is called evlved-com. They auto-connect when you sign in to Vercel with GitHub.

STEP 03 · DNS

Pointed GoDaddy at Vercel.

Two records: an A record at @ pointing to Vercel's IP, and a CNAME at www pointing to cname.vercel-dns.com. Vercel walks you through it. Propagation took maybe an hour. After that the domain serves whatever I push.

STEP 04 · THE FIRST PAGE

Built the coming-soon page in Claude.

I described what I wanted: dark background, mountain mark logo, eyebrow line, italic gold subhead, email signup form, footer line. Claude wrote the whole index.html in one response. I pasted it into the repo. Pushed. Live within a minute.

STEP 05 · EMAIL CAPTURE

Set up Kit.com and wired the form.

Created a free Kit account. Made a form, got the form ID. Replaced Kit's embed with a custom-styled signup that posts to Kit's API in the background. On success, the user gets a "check your email" message. On failure, an error. Took an hour, including the back-and-forth with Claude to get the styling right.

PART 3 · PLAYBOOKS

Steps 06 to 10

STEP 06 · EMAIL FORWARDING

Set up info@evlved.com via ImprovMX.

Free. Two MX records added at GoDaddy. Mail sent to info@evlved.com forwards into my real Gmail. Replies don't come from the address (you'd need Google Workspace for that), but for receiving and looking professional from day one, this is the move.

STEP 07 · SENDER AUTHENTICATION

Authenticated the domain in Kit (SPF, DKIM, DMARC).

Kit gives you four DNS records to add at your registrar. Once they validate, your launch emails go out from info@evlved.com without landing in spam. This step is boring, but skipping it kills your open rate later.

STEP 08 · CONFIRMATION EMAIL

Wrote the confirm and welcome emails in my own voice.

Kit defaults are generic. I rewrote them. "Almost in. One click to confirm." Friendly, short, says what's happening. No marketing speak. The welcome email goes out after confirm and tells them what's coming, in the same voice as the site.

STEP 09 · THANK-YOU PAGE

Built /thank-you.html, branded, same vibe.

After clicking the confirm link, the user lands on a thank-you page on my own domain instead of Kit's default. Same dark background, same mountain mark. "You're in." Lists the four systems with the one-line description for each. Personal sign-off.

STEP 10 · WELCOME AUTOMATION

Set up the Kit sequence that sends the welcome email.

In Kit, Automate → Sequences. New sequence with a name you'll remember. One email inside it, the welcome message. Then an automation rule: when someone subscribes to your form, add them to the Welcome sequence. Set once. Runs forever.

MY TAKE

*Half of this work was DNS and email plumbing. Not glamorous. But this is the part that separates a site that **works** from a site that just exists.*

THE PRODUCT SITE

EVLVED.com is a fully live, fully functional product site built entirely with the stack described in Part 2. Here is exactly how it came together.

The site has a hero section, four product cards — one per system in numbered order — prices, descriptions, and a bundle CTA below the four cards. Built the same way as everything else: described what I wanted, Claude built the HTML and CSS, iterated until it was right. The whole site is a handful of files. No framework. No build step. No JavaScript framework. Just clean HTML and CSS.

Payments run through Stripe. The PDFs are delivered automatically on purchase via the success page, which detects which product was bought and serves the right download links. Receipt goes to the buyer's inbox. The whole flow — click buy, pay, download — is live and working.

Custom email sending via Google Workspace means info@evlved.com both receives and sends. Replies to customers go out from the real address.

WHAT IT COST

1. Domain: ~\$15/year
2. Vercel: \$0
3. Kit: \$0 (free up to 10k subscribers)
4. ImprovMX: \$0
5. GitHub: \$0
6. Stripe: 0 monthly — pays per transaction only
7. Claude: covered by Pro subscription

Total cash cost to launch: roughly the price of the domain. Time cost: maybe twenty hours spread over a couple of weeks, because most of it was making decisions, not doing work.

MY TAKE

The hard part of building anything is not the building. It's the deciding. Once you know what you want, the tools take an evening.

MY TAKE

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How to use this as a template

If you want to build a similar site (digital products, email capture, simple structure), this is your sequence:

1. Decide the name and the four pieces (or however many).
2. Buy the domain.
3. GitHub + Vercel + DNS.
4. Coming-soon page with Claude.
5. Kit + email forwarding + DNS authentication.
6. Confirm + welcome emails in your voice.
7. Build the real product page later, when you have a launch date.
8. Wire payment last.

PART 3 · PLAYBOOKS

How I'd build *an online store.*

Same principles, different shape. The store is just a different kind of site that takes money and ships products. Here's how I'd approach it today.

I'm not going to give you a 200-step Shopify guide. There are plenty of those, and most of them are old. I'm going to give you the approach. The approach is what survives when the tools change.

Step zero: should this be a store at all?

If you're selling one product, you might not need a "store." A single landing page with a buy button is faster, cleaner, and converts better. Stores are for catalogues. If you have five things or fifty, build a store. If you have one thing, build a landing page.

If it's a store

STEP 01 · PLATFORM

Shopify, or Stripe + a custom site.

Shopify is the default. Pay the monthly fee, get the store, get the apps, get the inventory and shipping management. Worth it if you have real products and don't want to handle the infrastructure yourself.

Custom site with Stripe is the alternative. More control, less monthly cost, more work. Pick this if you're technical enough to enjoy the trade-off.

STEP 02 · BRAND & PHOTOGRAPHY

This is where most stores lose.

Product photos are 80% of the difference between a store that converts and one that doesn't. Spend on this. Or learn to do it yourself with a tripod, a window, and a white wall. AI image tools can help, but real photos still win for trust.

STEP 03 · THE FIRST TRAFFIC

Don't run ads until your store works on warm traffic.

Send the link to friends, your existing audience, anyone who'd buy. Watch what they do. Fix what they get stuck on. Only spend on ads once you've seen real strangers buy at full price without help.

STEP 04 · ADS WHEN READY

Test small. Scale what works.

Meta ads are the default for ecommerce. Run small tests with different creative (this is where Arcads, Creatify, and the AI ad tools earn their keep), see which version gets the lowest cost per purchase, scale that one. Kill the losers fast.

The thing nobody tells you

An online store is mostly logistics. Inventory, shipping, returns, customer service. The fun part is the brand and the launch. The unfun part is the next year of fulfilling orders. Plan for the unfun part before you build the fun part.

MY TAKE

I ran an ecommerce business with a team. The build was the easy month. The next year was the work. Don't romanticise the build.

PART 3 · PLAYBOOKS

How I'd build *a content business.*

A content business is one where attention earns money. You build an audience, you monetise the audience. The path is simple. The execution is consistency.

What you're actually building

You're not building "content." You're building trust at scale. Content is the medium. Trust is the asset. The mistake most creators make is optimising for content metrics (views, likes) instead of for the trust that converts to dollars.

STEP 01 · PICK A TOPIC AND A FORMAT

Narrow on both axes.

A specific topic and a specific format. Not "fitness." Try "training tips for guys over 35 with bad knees." Not "all platforms." Try "vertical video on Instagram." The riches are in the niches because the audience is in the niches.

STEP 02 · SHIP 90 DAYS OF CONTENT

Before you do anything else.

Post every day for three months. Don't optimise. Don't worry about views. Don't change format. You're not trying to grow yet. You're trying to learn how to make content fast, and to find your voice on camera or on the page. Almost everyone quits before this 90-day window closes. That's why almost everyone fails.

STEP 03 · LOOK AT THE DATA

Find the three best pieces. Make more of those.

After 90 days, you'll have 90 data points. Three of them will have done way better than the others. That's your signal. Now make versions of those three for the next 90 days.

STEP 04 · BUILD THE EMAIL LIST

An audience you don't own is an audience you can lose.

Instagram, TikTok, YouTube can change their algorithm or ban your account tomorrow. Email doesn't. Build the list from day one. Lead magnet, signup form on every link, simple welcome sequence. Kit handles all of this.

STEP 05 · MONETISE

Sell your own thing.

Sponsorships are nice. Ad revenue is nicer. Selling your own product is the move. You control the price, the margin, the customer relationship. Digital products like this book are the easiest to start with. Physical products, services, and software come later.

MY TAKE

A content business is a marathon disguised as a sprint. The first six months feel slow. Then it compounds. The people who quit in month four miss the curve.

PART 3 · PLAYBOOKS

The principle: *anything is buildable.*

If you take one thing from Part 3, take this. The specific playbooks above are examples. The principle is what makes them all work.

You can build anything you want with a stack of AIs and an imagination. The site you saw built in Playbook 1. The store. The content business. They're all the same shape underneath: pick a thing, find the smallest version that works, ship it, iterate.

The shape of any project

1. **A clear picture of the finished thing.** Not a perfect picture. Just a real one.
2. **A smallest version of it that ships this week or this month.**
3. **A list of tools that get you there.** (Part 2 is mostly your list.)
4. **A first move you can make in the next hour.**
5. **Discipline to keep going when it stops being fun.**

That's it. Same five steps for a side project, a real business, an app, a book, a course, a physical product. The tools change. The shape doesn't.

What the AI age changes

Step 3 (the tools) used to be the bottleneck. You'd want to build a site and you couldn't because you didn't know how to code. You'd want to make a logo and you couldn't because you couldn't draw. You'd want to launch a product and you couldn't because you didn't have a team.

Now the tools are free or near-free and the AI replaces the team. Step 3 takes a weekend.

Steps 1, 2, 4, and 5 are still on you. Picture. Smallest version. First move. Discipline. Those are the things you have to bring. The tools can't.

MY TAKE

*Five years ago you needed a team to build what one person with a laptop builds today. The leverage is real. Most people are still acting like it's 2020. **Don't be most people.***

The lock-in

Lock this in before Part 4. If you believe building anything is hard, you'll keep finding reasons it's hard. If you believe it's straightforward and the only question is whether you'll do the reps, you'll start. The belief comes first. The proof comes after you've built one thing. After that you'll believe it forever.

Build one thing. Anything. Even badly. Then come back and read this page again.

PART FOUR

The *practical.*

Getting paid, staying organised, when to hire, and the real mistakes. The things nobody talks about until they cost you money.

PART 4 · THE PRACTICAL

Getting paid *online.*

Three tools cover almost every situation. Stripe to take money. Wise to receive across countries. Revolut for the daily card. Plus a local bank as the backbone.

Stripe: the default for taking money

If you're selling anything online (digital, physical, subscription, one-off), Stripe is the default. It takes about an hour to set up. You'll need: business info, ID, bank account for payouts, and a basic understanding of what you're selling.

Stripe charges roughly 2.9% + a fixed fee per transaction in most countries. That's the cost of taking cards. You can't really go lower without trade-offs. Bake it into your pricing.

WHAT STRIPE HANDLES FOR YOU

- Card payments (every major card, in most currencies)
- Subscriptions and one-off charges
- Invoices (you can send a paid invoice to any email)
- Receipts (automatic, branded)
- Refunds and chargebacks
- Tax calculation (with Stripe Tax, paid add-on)

Wise: for international money

Wise gives you local bank account details in multiple currencies. If you sell to people in the US, the EU, the UK, and Australia, you can have a local account in each. You receive money like a local, then move it to your home currency at near-mid-market rates.

If you've ever paid 5% to a traditional bank for an international transfer, Wise will feel like cheating. Use it.

Revolut: for the daily card

The card you spend with day to day. Multi-currency, virtual cards on demand, decent FX, free tier works for most. Premium tier if you travel constantly or want better insurance and lounge access.

The local bank: don't skip it

Revolut and Wise are fintechs. They're great until something breaks. Keep at least one real bank account in your home country. Tax authority links, wires, the backstop when something else fails. Two of everything is the rule.

MY TAKE

Have two cards on different networks (Visa and Mastercard), two banks at minimum, and at least one fintech. The day Revolut freezes your account is the day you'll be glad you did.

PART 4 · THE PRACTICAL

Staying organised *when you're solo.*

Solo doesn't mean disorganised. It means you have to be the structure that a team would normally provide. Here's how I actually do it.

The five surfaces

I split my work across five surfaces. Each one does something the others can't.

1. THE WHITEBOARD (WEEK AND QUARTER)

Physical, on a wall. Big enough to see the whole picture. Here I map out the quarter, the big projects, the priorities. Updated weekly. The point of the whiteboard is perspective. You can't get perspective on a screen.

2. MONDAY.COM (ACTIVE PROJECTS)

Everything I'm actually working on, in boards. Tasks have statuses, owners (me, when solo; collaborators when not), due dates. Comments on tasks for context that needs to survive. Chat for things that don't.

3. NOTION (KNOWLEDGE AND REFERENCES)

The stuff that's not a task but I need to find later. Templates, swipe files, contact info, business documentation, processes I've written down so I don't forget them. Notion is the brain I can search.

4. APPLE NOTES (CAPTURE)

The thing I open when an idea hits while walking. Two seconds to capture. Don't try to make this organised. Just capture. Sort later, if at all.

5. THE NOTEBOOK (DAILY)

Handwritten, every morning. Today's list. Big rocks first. Then the smaller stuff. Crossing things off by hand does something to the brain that crossing them off in software doesn't.

The rule

Don't keep the same information in two places. Pick which surface a thing lives on, and put it there. The number one cause of system collapse is duplicating information across tools.

MY TAKE

Solo founders fail more often from chaos than from competition.

Organisation is a competitive advantage when you're alone.

The daily ritual

- Morning: write today's three big things in the notebook.
- Mid-morning: do the hardest one first.
- Afternoon: do the next two.
- End of day: cross off, write tomorrow's three.
- End of week: ten-minute review at the whiteboard.

That's it. No app. No subscription. The system is the discipline of doing it, not the tools you do it with.

PART 4 · THE PRACTICAL

When to stay solo, *when to hire.*

AI gets you further alone than ever before. There's still a ceiling. The question is when you hit it, and what to do when you do.

What solo means now

Solo doesn't mean alone. It means one decision-maker. You can use AI to do the work of five people. You can hire freelancers for specific tasks without putting them on payroll. You can run a real business as a one-person operation in a way that wasn't possible ten years ago.

Right now I'm running solo. AI handles what a team used to. Notion, Monday, the messaging stack keep me organised. I've had assistants in the past when the workload spiked. I'll have them again when it spikes again.

Signs you should stay solo

- You can still keep up with the work in a normal week.
- You're still in the figuring-it-out phase, not the scaling phase.
- You don't have a clear, repeatable task to hand off.
- You enjoy the work itself, not just the result.

Signs you should hire

- You're working weekends and the work is still growing.
- There's a specific, repeatable task that eats hours every week (admin, customer support, video editing, social posting).
- You're saying no to opportunities because you don't have capacity.
- The work that pays the most is the work you can't get to because the smaller stuff fills your day.

What to hire first

A virtual assistant for the repetitive stuff. Email triage, scheduling, simple research, customer support replies. This is the highest-leverage first hire because it gives you back hours that go straight back into building.

After that, a specialist for whatever your bottleneck is. Editor if you're a creator. Developer if you're shipping code. Customer support agent if you have a product with users.

MY TAKE

I built and sold a chat support and VA business. I know what good remote teams look like. The right first hire saves you ten hours a week. The wrong one costs you twenty.

How to hire well

- Write the role before you write the job post. What exactly are they doing, every day?
- Pay a real rate. Cheap hires cost more in the long run.
- Test with a paid trial task before committing. Two weeks tells you everything.
- Be specific about how you'll measure their work. Vague expectations create resentful workers.
- Don't outsource judgment. Outsource execution.

PART 4 · THE PRACTICAL

Mistakes I made *so you don't have to.*

Nine principles, pulled from real mistakes. The \$30k loss, the businesses I almost quit too early, the ones I pushed too long. Take what's useful, ignore what doesn't apply.

None of this is theory. Each one cost me time or money or both.

01

Know when to quit, know when to push.

Most people get both directions wrong. They quit things three months in when they should have pushed another six. Or they pour another year into something that should have been killed a year ago.

I almost quit the chat support business in the first three months. Earned nothing. Looked like a flop. I pushed through. It changed my life and I sold it clean. If I'd quit at month two, the whole arc wouldn't have happened.

The perfume vending business is the other side. I invested heavily upfront. ROI is now long. I'm not quitting (it still works) but I should have moved smaller, slower, tested cheaper. Knowing when to push is a skill. So is knowing when to slow down.

02

No risk, no story.

Every interesting outcome in my life came after I took a real risk. Leaving the hospitality job. Putting money into trading when I didn't know if it would work. Building businesses from scratch with no safety net.

Risks that don't sting aren't risks. The point isn't to be reckless. The point is that the upside you want lives on the other side of a decision that scares you.

03

Test cheap. Test fast. Invest to learn, not to prove yourself right.

Most expensive lessons come from skipping the small test. From going big before you've proven small. From spending a year and \$50k on something you could have validated in a weekend with a landing page.

Whatever you want to build, find the cheapest, fastest version that proves the core assumption. Then spend.

0 4

Network and ask for help.

Solo doesn't mean alone. The biggest unlocks in my life came from conversations. From people I met because I went somewhere, sat down with them, picked their brain.

I've travelled to other countries to meet people. Spent on lunches and dinners. Reached out cold. Most people say yes. The ones that say no don't matter. The ones that say yes can change your trajectory.

0 5

Research before you start.

Not for years. Not until you're ready (you'll never feel ready). But enough that you understand the basics, the players, the obvious traps. A weekend of real research before a big move is the cheapest insurance there is.

PART 4 · THE PRACTICAL

Principles 06 to 09

06

If it seems too good to be true, it is.

I lost \$30k in a private investment during Covid. It all seemed smooth, easy, quick returns. Until it failed overnight. The signs were there. Smooth and easy is almost never how real wealth is built.

People close to me have lost much more on similar setups. The pattern is always the same. Promised returns above the market. Pressure to put in more. Stories about other people getting rich. A small, plausible-looking initial return to build trust. Then the wall.

If you ever feel rushed into a "great opportunity" with quick returns, walk away. The opportunities that are real will still be there next week. The ones that disappear next week were never opportunities.

07

Invest in yourself.

Courses. Books. Travel to meet people. Expensive lunches and dinners to pick brains. Time spent reading, watching, building, learning. The return on these is unlimited compared to almost anything you can invest in.

I've spent on all of them. The time investment is the biggest one. Money buys courses. Time builds skill. Most people don't put in the time.

08

Losing money or businesses is not the end.

I've lost money. I've closed businesses. The feeling is real. It sits in your chest for weeks. But every one of those losses was the lesson that built the next thing.

If you're in the middle of a loss right now, get through it. Don't quit on the whole game because one round went badly. The next round is where the lesson pays off.

09

Discipline holds it all together.

Every principle in this book, every tool, every playbook, every mistake avoided. It all comes back to whether you do the work consistently or not.

Discipline System (Vol. 01) is the foundation for a reason. If you haven't read it, read it. The income work doesn't happen without the daily habits that produce it.

MY TAKE

*Every successful person I've met has lost real money or shut down a real thing at some point. The difference between them and the people who never make it is they didn't stop. **The losses are tuition.***

One last thing

If this is the only book on building online businesses you read, you have enough. More books, more courses, more videos will not change the equation. The thing that changes the equation is whether you put this down today and start building something tonight.

Start small. Start ugly. Start now.

EVLVED.
Vol. 04

Evolve *beyond.*

Four systems. The way I actually live. Discipline. Fitness. Travel. Income. Pillar by pillar, in your own words and your own time.

N° 01 The Discipline System

AVAILABLE NOW

N° 02 The Fitness System

AVAILABLE NOW

N° 03 The Travel System

AVAILABLE NOW

N° 04 The Income System

YOU ARE HERE

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